Shansabani elites spent only the summer months of the year at Firuzkuh, despite this "capital" being monumentally conceived, as noted above. It was approximately forty *farsang*s to the south in the region of Zamindawar, and probably at a specific location therein, that the Shansabanis spent the winter months.[28] Firuzkuh, then, was essentially the Shansabanis' *sard-sir* or summer encampment of their seasonally transhumant existence, complemented by the *garm-sir* or over-wintering area in the region of Zamindawar near the borders of Sistan.[29] For our present purposes, these predictable movements furnish the broad regional span of the pre-imperial Shansabanis during the eleventh–twelfth centuries.

Ahangaran and Jam-Firuzkuh (Figures 2.1 and 2.2) merit juxtaposition not only for their locations along the Hari Rud, but also for their varying suitability as the Shansabanis' eventual *sard-sir* royal encampment. Indeed, scholarly debate as to whether Jam-Firuzkuh was in fact the Shansabani summer "capital" endured through much of the twentieth century, centering precisely on the site's *un*suitability. Aside from the admittedly magnificent *minar* (Figure 2.2) and even with the archaeological recovery of its adjacent, monumental mosque (cf. Chapters 3 and 4), little else indicates the site's royal status. Furthermore, its location was remote, not easily accessible along the northern routes from Herat toward Balkh; and its fastness in a mountainous landscape provided limited space for pasturage, also being insufficient for seasonal agriculture along with the encampments of royal retainers and soldiery. By contrast, Ahangaran (Figures 2.1 and 2.3) met most of these requirements, with its location on a well-watered plain. This locality had the added advantages of being one of the crossing points of the Hari Rud, as well as having ancestral associations for the pre-imperial Shansabanis.[30] Nevertheless, little doubt now remains that the Shansabanis chose Jam-Firuzkuh over Ahangaran as the site for their summer residence.

Beyond the above-mentioned migration patterns, little precision is forthcoming in delineating the southern extent of Ghur. Zamindawar as a historical region has been identified, of course, but in the current state of scholarship a specific locality as the likely site of the Shansabanis' winter "capital" can be only tentatively suggested. Calculations of its possible location have been put forth, though inconclusively, based on Juzjani's mentions of distance from Firuzkuh and comparison with the numerous fortifications identified in the southern part of Ghur, particularly in the area of Taiwara and perhaps beyond[31] (then extending into modern Farah province), as discussed below. Southern Ghur was evidently well-watered by its three rivers: the long Farah Rud, the Rud-i Ghur, and the Khwash Rud. By the twelfth century, then, it was this *c.* 250-km expanse from northern Ghur to the borders of historical Zamindawar and Sistan that constituted the core home region of the eventual Shansabani elites and their seasonal transhumance.